

PURPOSE: To abolish the wellness seminar requirements and allow seminars to count towards wellness hours.

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BE IT RESOLVED BY THE MISSISSIPPI SCHOOL FOR MATHEMATICS AND SCIENCE

SECTION ONE (DEFINITIONS):

Wellness Seminar: Any event, exposition, competition, meeting, etc. that counts towards the 2 wellness seminars per quarter requirement for certain res life plans. *

*It is recommended to view the infographic distributed by Res Life staff, which contains definite stipulations for the contents of a “wellness seminar.”

SECTION TWO (REASONING):

Meeting wellness requirements at MSMS often poses a significant challenge to regularly overworked and busy students. Obtaining fifteen hours of physical activity is difficult, and wellness seminars only add another layer of stress to the whole ordeal. Wellness seminars are often inconveniently scheduled— many seminars are scheduled around 4 PM, when most club activities begin— and it is easy to find oneself scrambling to meet the seminar requirement at the end of a quarter. This bill attempts to kill (or at least maim) two birds with one stone by merging the two wellness requirements.

By abolishing the seminar requirement, an unnecessary avenue of wellness incompleteness is removed, while also providing more ways to complete the remaining hourly wellness requirement. The main obstacle is ensuring that wellness seminars do not become obsolete. To this effect this bill proposes that wellness seminars are worth two (2) wellness hours. This would make meeting the wellness requirement significantly easier. Completing two wellness seminars would reduce the hours needed by four, and one could choose to attend more seminars if they wish.

The beauty of this proposition is that wellness hours and wellness seminars are already interchangeable. One could reasonably sign out on orange card to go watch a MSMS-hosted movie, and events like these are regularly worth seminar credits. Why not merge the two and remove an unnecessary requirement?

SECTION THREE (SPECIFIC CHANGE):

On page 53 of the Student Handbook (PDF page 58) under the section “MSMS NON-ACADEMIC REQUIREMENTS FOR GRADUATION” the following would be changed to:

MSMS NON-ACADEMIC REQUIREMENTS FOR GRADUATION

Wellness

The MSMS Wellness Program requires each student to participate in a minimum number of ~~physical activity hours and minimum attendance in wellness seminars~~ wellness hours, which can be obtained via physical activity or attending wellness seminars, as directed by the coordinator for this program and explained during orientation.

SECTION THREE (SPECIFIC CHANGE) (contd.):

On page 106 of the Student Handbook (PDF page 111) under the section “WELLNESS” the following would be changed to:

WELLNESS

The links among nutrition, physical activity, and learning are well-documented. MSMS is committed to providing a school environment that enhances learning and the development of lifelong wellness practices. To ensure that all MSMS students have the opportunity to develop the knowledge and skills necessary to make nutritious food choices and enjoyable physical activity a valuable part of daily life, they are required to participate in a wellness component as a requirement for graduation. The wellness program requirements ~~s-include a combination of wellness seminars and physical activity-~~ consists of a set number of wellness hours that must be obtained by physical activity or attending wellness seminars. All wellness seminars are worth two (2) wellness hours. Wellness grades will have an impact on eligibility for privilege plans, and failure to maintain a satisfactory “S” grade in wellness will be a consideration when extending invitations to return. Details regarding the wellness component will be provided during class orientations.